

RAIDBOUND

Game Design Document | v1.0

Dungeon Extraction RPG — Roblox

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1. Executive Summary

Raidbound is a dungeon-extraction RPG for Roblox. Players enter procedurally-modified dungeons, fight enemies, collect loot, and face a single core decision: extract safely now, or push deeper for better rewards at greater risk.

The game is deliberately not an open-world MMORPG. Its tight loop — Enter → Fight → Loot → Extract → Upgrade — is designed to deliver satisfying 5–20 minute sessions while feeding long-term progression hooks that drive daily return.

Core Emotion

"Do I extract now with what I have, or risk losing everything for something better?"

Design Pillars

- • Tension — every run has meaningful stakes
 - • Clarity — new players grasp the loop within 2 minutes
 - • Social Proof — accomplishment must be visible to others
 - • Replayability — no two runs feel identical
 - • Forgiving Dungeons, Punishing Raids — difficulty scales with stakes
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2. Critical Analysis & Recommended Changes

2.1 What to Keep (High Value)

- Extraction tension — this is the entire identity of the game. Never dilute it.
- Personal loot — eliminates social friction; essential for Roblox's social graph.
- Dungeon mutations — cheap to implement, massively extends replayability.
- Item mutations (Flaming, Frozen, etc.) — these are the trading economy engine.
- Housing as prestige display — proven retention driver in Adopt Me and Steal a Brainrot.
- Gold as progression fallback — prevents loot-unlucky players from churning.

2.2 Risks to Address

- 6 loot rarities at launch is too many. Simplify to 4 (Common / Rare / Epic / Mythic). Add Legendary later when the economy is understood.
- Zone 1 spanning Levels 1–25 with 3–5 dungeons means players could log 50+ runs before new content. Reduce Zone 1 to Levels 1–15, 3 dungeons maximum.
- AFK Progression should NOT be in MVP. Adds scope and complicates economy. Revisit post-launch.
- Guild System and Mounts should be Phase 2 minimum. Focus Phase 1 on the core loop.

2.3 Recommended Additions

- Daily Challenge Dungeon — one modified dungeon per day with bonus reward for first clear.
- Extraction Portal Countdown — 10-second countdown when triggered; party must confirm or be left behind.
- Bounty Board — 3 rotating daily objectives rewarding bonus gold + seasonal currency.
- Death Recap Screen — show what was lost on failed extraction. Motivates immediate re-entry.

2.4 The 20% That Drives 80% of Success

1. The extraction decision moment — every dungeon layout and loot placement must serve this tension.
 2. Social prestige visibility — players must see and envy rare items in the town hub within 10 minutes.
 3. Item mutations as trade bait — a Flaming Mythic is a collectible, not just a stat upgrade.
 4. Dungeon mutations — Golden Dungeon and Double Boss create jackpot moments players share.
 5. The Battle Pass — predictable daily revenue, gives free players a target, gives payers identity.
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3. Core Gameplay Loop

Primary Loop (5–20 min session)

1. Player enters Town Hub
2. Selects dungeon from portal board
3. Dungeon instance rolls its mutation (shown before entering)
4. Player fights through dungeon, collecting loot and gold
5. Player reaches extraction point
6. Decision: extract now, or continue deeper?
7. Successful extraction: loot kept, return to Town Hub
8. Spend gold, upgrade gear, display items
9. Repeat

Session Length Targets

Run Type	Duration	Primary Goal
Quick Run	5–10 min	Gold farming, daily bounty
Standard Run	10–20 min	Gear hunting, XP
Raid Run	20–40 min	Endgame loot, prestige

4. Dungeon Design

4.1 Difficulty Philosophy

Dungeons are forgiving. Raids are punishing. This split is intentional and must be maintained throughout development.

Setting	Death Penalty	Respawn	Extraction Points	Party Size
Dungeon	Drop held gold only	Yes — last checkpoint	Multiple (every 2–3 rooms)	1–3 players
Raid	Lose all unextracted loot + gold — full wipe		Fixed — end of wing only	3–5 players

4.2 Dungeon Forgiving Mechanics

- Checkpoint respawn: players respawn at the last cleared room
 - Downed state: 30-second window for allies to revive before death
 - Gold shield: gear and materials are never lost on death — only unbanked gold
 - Entry replenish: consumables partially refill on dungeon entry
- *This keeps new players in the game without removing all stakes.*

4.3 Raid Punishing Mechanics

- No respawn: full party wipe means dungeon reset
 - Loot risk: all unextracted loot and gold lost on wipe
 - Limited extraction: one checkpoint per raid wing only
 - Enrage timers: bosses enrage at 8 minutes if not defeated
- *Raids are opt-in. Free players must never be pushed into raids for core progression.*

4.4 Dungeon Mutations

Mutation	Effect	Rarity
Normal	Standard run	Common
Golden Dungeon	+50% gold, enemy shields enabled	Uncommon
Corrupted Dungeon	Enemies stronger, loot quality +1 tier	Uncommon
Haunted Dungeon	Enemy respawn, bonus rare boss chance	Rare
Treasure Dungeon	Extra chest rooms, no boss	Rare
Elite Dungeon	All enemies elite-tier, double loot table	Rare
Double Boss Dungeon	Two boss encounters, escalating loot	Very Rare
Rescue Event	Escort NPC to extraction for pet/mount reward	Very Rare

4.5 Zone Structure

Zone	Level Range	Dungeons	Theme
Zone 1 — The Blighted Reaches	1–15	3 + Capstone	Mines, crypts, forest hideouts
Zone 2 — The Shattered Kingdoms	16–35	4 + Capstone	Fortresses, cathedrals, strongholds
Zone 3 — The Abyssal Depths	36–60	4 + Capstone	Undersea ruins, cursed libraries

Zone	Level Range	Dungeons	Theme
Zone 4 — The Void Citadel	61–100	5 + Raid Wing	Endgame — cosmic horror theme

■ *Zone 1 is intentionally short. Players must reach Zone 2 within their first 3–4 sessions or early churn risk spikes.*

5. Character Progression

5.1 Levelling Curve

Level Range	Runs Required (Approx)	Key Unlock
1–5	3–5 runs	Basic abilities, all Zone 1 dungeons
6–10	5–8 runs	Talent tree unlocks
11–15	8–12 runs	Capstone Dungeon access
16–25	15–20 runs	Zone 2 access, class specialisation
26–50	40–60 runs	Zone 3, advanced mutations
51–100	80–120 runs	Zone 4, Prestige system

5.2 Classes

Class	Role	Playstyle	Key Mechanic
Warrior	Tank / CC	Frontline brawler	Taunt — forces enemies to target Warrior for 5s
Ranger	Ranged DPS	Kite and burst	Mark — increases crit chance vs marked target
Mage	Burst / AoE	High risk, high reward	Arcane Surge — 3x damage, then 4s cooldown

5.3 Talent Trees

- Warrior: Juggernaut (sustain) / Warlord (damage) / Guardian (group protection)
- Ranger: Sniper (single-target) / Trickster (mobility) / Beastmaster (pet synergy — future)
- Mage: Arcane (burst) / Frost (crowd control) / Shadow (DoT and drain)

Players choose one path per character — permanent but resettable for gold.

6. Loot System

6.1 Rarity Tiers

Rarity	Colour	Boss Drop Rate	Notes
Common	Grey	50%	Vendor fodder or upgrade material
Rare	Blue	30%	Meaningful upgrades for 3–5 levels
Epic	Purple	15%	Chase gear — worth upgrading
Mythic	Orange	5%	Zone-spanning power, trade magnet

6.2 Item Mutations

Mutation	Stat Bonus	Visual Effect	Trade Value
Flaming	+8% fire damage	Flame particle trail	High
Frozen	+8% crit chance	Ice shard visual	High
Corrupted	+12% dmg / -5% def	Dark aura pulse	Very High
Golden	+15% gold find	Gold shimmer	Medium
Ancient	+5% all stats	Faint rune glow	Very High
Spectral	+10% attack speed	Ghost particle effect	High

■ Mutations are the primary driver of the trading economy. A Corrupted Mythic sword is a collectible, not just a stat upgrade.

6.3 Jackpot Moments

Every 10 boss kills, a hidden Jackpot Roll triggers with a 10% chance of a bonus rare drop. Players never see this mechanic — they simply experience unexpectedly lucky runs. These moments generate social sharing.

7. Extraction System

7.1 Core Mechanics

- Extraction points appear after clearing a room, marked by a glowing portal
- Dungeons: multiple extraction points (every 2–3 cleared rooms)
- Raids: one fixed extraction per wing only
- When triggered, a 10-second countdown begins — visible to all party members
- Players can join extraction or stay behind and continue solo

7.2 What You Keep vs Lose

Outcome	Gear	Gold	Materials	XP
Successful Extraction	Keep all	Keep all	Keep all	Full XP
Death (Dungeon)	Keep all	Lose unbanked gold	Keep all	75% XP
Full Wipe (Raid)	Keep all	Lose all unextracted	Lose unextracted	50% XP

■ Gear is NEVER lost on death. Gear loss creates rage-quit moments. Gold loss is sufficient for tension.

7.3 Death Recap Screen

On failed extraction, players see exactly what gold was lost with a prompt: "That Rare Sword nearly made it out. Try again?" This drives immediate re-entry.

8. Economy Design

8.1 Currency Overview

Currency	Earned From	Spent On	Tradeable?
Gold	Enemies, bosses, quests, selling loot	Upgrades, repairs, talent resets, storage	No
Event Tokens	Seasonal event quests and bosses	Event cosmetics, limited pets, housing items	No
Robux	Real money purchase	Battle Pass, cosmetics, extra slots, XP boosts	No

8.2 Gold Sinks

- Gear upgrade costs (scales steeply per tier)
- Talent resets
- Storage expansion
- Trade Bench listing fee (1% of trade value, destroyed)
- Housing cosmetic unlock costs

8.3 Trading Economy

- Trading occurs only at the Trade Bench in the Town Hub
 - Both parties must confirm before items exchange
 - Trade history logged and viewable for 7 days
 - Item mutations drive the majority of trade activity
 - 1% gold listing fee on all trades acts as a gold sink
- Do NOT implement player-to-Robux trading or any Robux resale mechanic. Creates regulatory and ToS risk.

9. Town Hub & Housing

9.1 Town Hub Layout

Location	Function
Dungeon Portal Board	Select dungeon, view mutation, form party
Blacksmith	Gear upgrades (gold + materials)
Enchanter	Apply/remove mutations (high cost)
Trade Bench	Player-to-player trades
Storage Vault	Account-wide shared storage
Quest Board	Daily and weekly bounties
Town Showcase Board	Public leaderboards — rarest items, fastest clears
Housing Portal	Enter personal home instance
Seasonal Vendor	Active during events only

9.2 Town Showcase Board

This must be placed at the centre of the hub, impossible to miss. It is one of the most powerful retention features in the game.

- Recent Mythic drops — player name, item, mutation
- Fastest dungeon clear this week
- Top gold earner today
- Most rare boss kills this week

9.3 Housing

- Every player receives a personal home on tutorial completion
- Character Display Podiums: up to 5 characters displayed with full gear visible
- Trophy Wall: boss kill trophies, rare item frames, dungeon records
- Collection Showcase: rare pets, mounts (Phase 2), event items
- Expansion slots: unlock more room for gold or Robux

■ Visitors to your home should understand your progression level within 5 seconds.

10. Monetisation Design

10.1 Principles

- Free-to-play players must always be viable in all core content
- No direct purchase of endgame gear
- Pay-for-convenience and pay-for-cosmetic are acceptable
- Limited pay-for-power acceptable (XP/gold boosts) following Blox Fruits model

10.2 Monetisation Products

Product	Type	Est. Robux	Notes
Battle Pass	Seasonal progression	499	Primary recurring revenue — 40-tier reward track
XP Boost (24hr)	Convenience	99	+50% XP for 24 hours
Gold Boost (24hr)	Convenience	99	+50% gold for 24 hours
Extra Character Slot	Expansion	299	Players start with 2; max 5
Storage Expansion	Convenience	149/tier	Up to 3 purchasable tiers
Cosmetic Bundle	Cosmetic	299–599	Character skins, weapon effects
Housing Pack	Cosmetic	199–399	Furniture, themes, decorations
VIP Server	Social	200/mo	Private dungeon server for a group

10.3 Battle Pass Structure

- 40 tiers — approx 3 weeks of daily play to complete
 - Free track: gold bundles, materials, one cosmetic at tier 40
 - Paid track: exclusive armour skin, animated weapon effect, unique title, exclusive pet (Phase 2)
 - Battle Pass items are never resold — scarcity drives purchase
- **Never gate zone or story progression behind Robux. Level locking must be time + skill based only.**

11. Progression Systems

11.1 Gear Upgrade System

Tier	Stat Gain	Gold Cost	Additional Requirement
Tier 1 → 2	+10% base stats	500	x2 Common materials
Tier 2 → 3	+12% base stats	1,500	x2 Uncommon materials
Tier 3 → 4	+15% base stats	4,000	x1 Rare material + boss trophy
Tier 4 → 5	+20% base stats	10,000	x1 Epic material + capstone trophy

11.2 Daily & Weekly Systems

System	Reset	Rewards	Design Intent
Daily Login	Daily	Gold, XP boost, material	Return habit — non-punishing for missed days
Daily Challenge Dungeon	Daily	Bonus gold + event token	Drives active engagement, not passive
Bounty Board (x3)	Daily	Gold + seasonal currency	Provides directed goals each session
Weekly Boss Challenge	Weekly	Guaranteed Epic + large gold	Social event — players discuss in hub

11.3 Prestige System (Phase 2)

- At Level 100, players may Prestige — reset to Level 1 but retain all gear, gold, and cosmetics
- Grants unique aura visible in Town Hub and dungeons
- Exclusive Prestige title tier (Prestige I through X)
- Bonus drop rate modifier (+1% per Prestige level, max +10%)

12. Roblox Technical Architecture

12.1 Server Architecture

Context	Server Type	Max Players	Notes
Town Hub	Shared server	50	Social centre — must always feel populated
Dungeon	Private instance	3	One instance per party — instancing is non-negotiable
Raid	Private instance	5	One instance per party
Housing	Private instance	10 visitors	Player + up to 10 guests

12.2 DataStore Structure

Store Name	Key Format	Contents
PlayerData	Player_{UserId}	Level, XP, gold, class, talents, equipped gear
Inventory_{UserId}	Slot_{N}	Item ID, rarity, mutation, tier, stats
CollectionBook_{UserId}	Category_{Type}	Discovery booleans, kill counts
HousingData_{UserId}	House_{UserId}	Placed items, podium characters, layout
TradeHistory	Trade_{Timestamp}	Both player IDs, items exchanged, gold
Leaderboards	Board_{Type}	Ordered score data for showcase board

■ Use ProfileService or equivalent DataStore wrapper. Never write raw DataStore calls — data corruption at scale is a studio-killing bug.

12.3 Anti-Exploit Priorities

- All loot generation must be server-side — never trust client loot claims
- Extraction validation must run server-side with position checks
- Gold transactions must be atomic — use DataStore batching
- Rate-limit trading to prevent gold duplication exploits

13. Development Roadmap

Phase 1 — MVP (Months 1–4)

Goal: prove the core loop is fun. Everything else is secondary.

- • Zone 1 only (3 dungeons + Capstone)
- • 2 classes: Warrior and Mage
- • 4 loot rarities
- • Dungeon mutations: Normal, Golden, Corrupted, Treasure
- • Extraction system with 10-second countdown and death recap
- • Personal loot + item mutations (Flaming, Frozen, Corrupted)
- • Town Hub: Blacksmith, Trade Bench, Quest Board, Showcase Board
- • Housing: basic home with 2 podiums
- • Battle Pass Season 1 + XP/gold boost packs
- • DataStore with ProfileService

Phase 2 — Expansion (Months 5–8)

- • Zone 2 (4 dungeons + Capstone)
- • Ranger class
- • All dungeon mutations + rescue events
- • Pet system (5 pets at launch)
- • Guild system (basic: shared chat and leaderboard)
- • Prestige system + Legendary loot tier
- • Battle Pass Season 2

Phase 3 — Scale (Months 9–12)

- • Zone 3 and Zone 4
 - • Healer class
 - • Mounts (cosmetic only)
 - • Guild Halls
 - • AFK companion tasks (supplement only — never replaces active play)
 - • First seasonal event
 - • Full Collection Book with zone-complete rewards
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14. Retention Analysis & Risk Register

14.1 Top Retention Drivers

- 1. Extraction tension — players return because they want to win the next run
- 2. Daily Challenge Dungeon — single best daily login driver
- 3. Town Showcase Board — social visibility creates aspiration
- 4. Battle Pass — progression tick every session
- 5. Item mutation hunting — "I need a Corrupted version of this" is an infinite loop
- 6. Housing prestige — players decorate and show off between runs

14.2 Churn Risk Register

Risk	Likelihood	Severity	Mitigation
Zone 1 too slow / too long	High	High	Cap Zone 1 at 15 levels, 3 dungeons. Monitor Day 3 retention.
Dungeon mutations feel rare	Medium	High	Set non-Normal mutation rate at 35%+ so players see variety quickly.
Trade economy dries up	Medium	Medium	Seed showcase board with NPC "recent drops" until player volume is sufficient.
Extraction feels punishing not fun	Medium	High	Never lose gear. Only gold loss. Test with focus groups before launch.
Solo players feel excluded	Medium	Medium	Ensure all Zone 1–2 content is soloable. Party = bonus, not requirement.
DataStore corruption at launch	Low	Critical	Use ProfileService. Load test at 500 CCU before release.

14.3 Success Metrics (Day 1–30)

- Day 1 retention target: >45%
- Day 7 retention target: >20%
- Day 30 retention target: >10%
- Average session length target: >12 minutes
- Battle Pass conversion rate target: >8% of DAU
- Trade Bench transactions per DAU: >0.3

END OF DOCUMENT

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